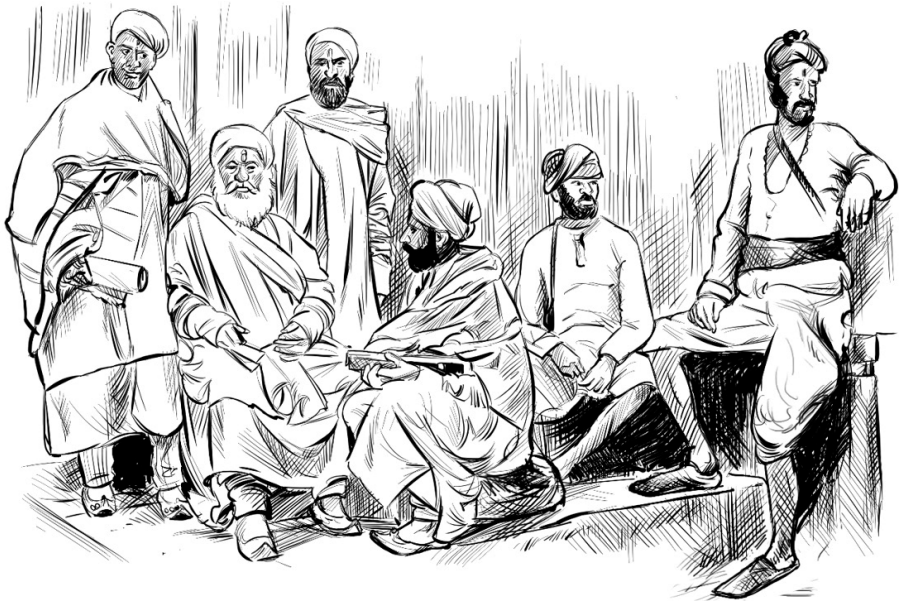
THE CASTE SYSTEM IN INDIA

IN TRADITIONAL HINDUISM AND INDIAN CULTURE, PEOPLE WERE DIVIDED INTO DIFFERENT SOCIAL LEVELS, OR CASTES.



RELIGIOUS PRIESTS AND TEACHERS MADE UP THE HIGHEST CASTE CALLED BRAHMANS. NEXT CAME KSHATRIYAS, THE WARRIORS AND ROYALTY. GANDHI'S FAMILY BELONGED TO THE NEXT CASTE-THE VAISHYAS-IN A SMALLER SUBGROUP CALLED THE MODH BANIAS. THE VAISHYA CASTE INCLUDED LANDOWNERS, MERCHANTS, AND FARMERS. THE SUDRAS MADE UP THE LOWEST CASTE. THESE WERE WORKERS AND CRAFTSMEN. PEOPLE COULD NOT MARRY MEMBERS OUTSIDE THEIR CASTE. THEY WERE NOT EVEN ALLOWED TO SHARE A MEAL WITH THEM!